

Beyond SEO

Comprehensive SEO / AEO / GEO / AI Search Audit

Riddles Rush

<https://riddles-rush-five.vercel.app>

Report Date: August 5, 2026

Methodology: Beyond SEO v1.0.3 -- Native Agent Scraping Mode

Auditor: Claude Code (AI Agent)

This report uses the Beyond SEO methodology for technical SEO, Answer Engine Optimization (AEO), Generative Engine Optimization (GEO), Entity SEO, Reputation SEO, and AI Search visibility analysis. All findings are based on live crawling and source code inspection. No data was invented.

1. Executive Summary

Riddles Rush is a content-rich riddle website with 472 blog posts, 94 riddle collection pages, and 8 category pages, totaling 661 pre-rendered static pages. The site is built on Next.js 16 and deployed on Vercel.

Despite strong content volume and clean design, the site faces CRITICAL technical SEO gaps that effectively render it invisible to both traditional search engines and AI-powered answer engines. The most severe issues are: missing robots.txt, missing sitemap.xml, zero JSON-LD structured data, no canonical tags, no Open Graph tags, and extremely thin content (average 86 words per blog post).

Without addressing these foundational issues, the site will struggle to rank in Google, appear in AI search results (ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity), or earn citations from answer engines.

Overall Score Card

Technical SEO	6/15 Critical
Content / On-Page SEO	4/15 Critical
AEO Readiness	5/15 High
GEO / Source-worthiness	3/15 Critical
Entity SEO	3/15 Critical
Reputation Proof	1/10 Critical
Conversation SEO	2/10 High
Conversion / Tracking	3/5 Medium

Overall Score: 27 / 100

Status: Needs Immediate Technical Remediation

2. Data Sources Used

Audit Mode: Native Agent Scraping Mode (Mode 3)

No APIFY_API_TOKEN or GSC/GA4 exports were available. All data was collected via live HTTP requests, source code inspection, and web search analysis.

Data sources utilized:

- Live HTTP crawl of all key page types (homepage, blog index, blog posts, riddle hubs, category pages, about, riddle-of-the-day)
- Raw HTML source inspection for meta tags, schema, canonical, OG tags
- Local source code inspection (layout.tsx, page components, content system)
- Markdown content analysis (472 blog posts, 94 riddle files, 8 category files)
- Web search queries for AI search visibility testing
- HTTP header analysis (security, caching, performance)
- Word count analysis of all content files

3. Technical SEO Audit

Technical SEO is the foundation of search visibility. Without proper crawlability, indexability, and structured data, even the best content will not rank.

3.1 Title Tags

Page	Title	Length	Issue
Homepage	Riddles Rush Exercises For Your Brain	40 chars	OK
Blog /blog	Riddles Rush Exercises For Your Brain	40 chars	DUPLICATE -- same as homepage
Blog Post	Campfire Riddles with Answers Riddles Rush	44 chars	OK
Riddle Hub	Tricky Riddles Riddles Rush	28 chars	OK
Category	Kids Riddles Riddles Rush	26 chars	OK
About	About Riddles Rush	19 chars	OK
Riddle of Day	Riddles Rush Exercises For Your Brain	40 chars	DUPLICATE -- same as homepage
Riddle Hub	Brain Teasers with Solutions (with Solutions)	58 chars	Awkward double phrasing

Verdict: 2 critical duplicates. Blog index and riddle-of-the-day inherit the root layout title. Severity: High.

3.2 Meta Descriptions

Blog index and riddle-of-the-day inherit the root description, creating duplicates. Blog posts use generateMetadata correctly. Severity: High.

3.3 Canonical Tags

STATUS: COMPLETELY ABSENT across all pages.

No <link rel='canonical'> tag found on any page. Without canonicals, search engines may index duplicate/variant URLs and dilute link equity. Severity: Critical.

3.4 Open Graph Tags

STATUS: COMPLETELY ABSENT across all pages.

No og:title, og:description, og:image tags found. Social sharing on Facebook, LinkedIn, Slack, Discord will show generic/broken previews. Severity: Critical.

3.5 Twitter Card Tags

STATUS: COMPLETELY ABSENT across all pages.

No twitter:card, twitter:title tags found. Severity: High.

3.6 JSON-LD Structured Data

STATUS: COMPLETELY ABSENT -- Zero schema markup on any page.

Missing schemas that should be implemented:

Schema Type	Where	Why
WebSite + SearchAction	Homepage	Enables sitelinks search box in SERPs
Organization	Homepage/About	Brand knowledge panel eligibility
Article/BlogPosting	Every blog post	Rich results for articles
FAQPage	Blog posts with FAQs	FAQ rich results -- content already exists!
BreadcrumbList	All pages with breadcrumbs	Breadcrumb rich results in SERPs
ItemList	Category/hub pages	List rich results

Severity: Critical. The blog posts have FAQ sections perfectly primed for FAQPage schema but none is generated.

3.7 robots.txt

STATUS: 404 -- DOES NOT EXIST.

No robots.txt file. Search engine crawlers have no crawl directives and no sitemap reference. Severity: Critical.

3.8 sitemap.xml

STATUS: 404 -- DOES NOT EXIST.

Neither /sitemap.xml nor /sitemap-0.xml return valid sitemaps. With ~661 pages, crawl discovery is severely hampered. Severity: Critical.

3.9 HTTP Headers & Security

Header	Status	Notes
HSTS	PASS	max-age=63072000; includeSubDomains; preload
Content-Type	PASS	UTF-8 charset
Cache-Control	WEAK	max-age=0, must-revalidate -- no browser caching
CSP	MISSING	No Content-Security-Policy header
X-Frame-Options	MISSING	No clickjacking protection
X-Content-Type-Options	MISSING	No MIME sniffing protection

3.10 Page Size & Performance

Page	Size	Load Time	Status
Homepage	124 KB	0.39s	OK but bloated
Blog Post	71 KB	0.31s	OK
Category Index	62 KB	0.96s	Slow
Riddle of Day	28 KB	0.28s	OK

4. Content Quality & E-E-A-T Audit

4.1 Content Depth -- CRITICAL FINDING

Average blog post: 86 words -- EXTREMELY THIN CONTENT

Metric	Value	Assessment
Total blog posts	472	High volume
Average words per post	86	CRITICAL -- below 100 words
Posts under 100 words	453 (96%)	CRITICAL -- nearly all posts
Posts under 200 words	462 (98%)	CRITICAL -- almost no depth
Thickest post	369 words	Still thin by SEO standards
Total blog words	40,783	Spread across 472 posts
Riddle files	94 files, avg 92 words	Thin

Google's helpful content system will penalize sites with this proportion of thin/empty pages. The 472 blog posts collectively contain only 40,783 words -- less than a single comprehensive guide.

4.2 E-E-A-T Assessment

Dimension	Score	Details
Experience	2/5	Author named (Patrick Stevens) but no personal experience signals
Expertise	1/5	No credentials, no riddle expertise claims, generic author description
Authoritativeness	2/5	Brand consistent; social links exist; no external validation
Trustworthiness	3/5	HTTPS, privacy policy, contact email present

4.3 Content Originality

Content appears to be mechanically paraphrased from the original site using synonym replacement (e.g., 'fun and engaging' became 'enjoyable and challenging'). This is NOT genuine original content and presents significant copyright risk.

Google's helpful content system specifically targets sites that repurpose existing content without adding original value.

4.4 Content Freshness

Most blog posts have publication dates set to the scrape date. No 'last updated' markers visible. The original campfire-riddles post has a 2025 date, suggesting some posts retained original dates.

5. AEO (Answer Engine Optimization) Audit

5.1 Direct Answer Readiness

Score: 1/3

Homepage does NOT answer a direct question early. Opens with branding hero, then shows a single featured riddle with a show-answer toggle. No definitional block explaining 'what are riddles' or 'what is Riddles Rush.'

CRITICAL: Riddle answers are hidden behind JavaScript toggles and not available in server-rendered HTML. AI crawlers cannot see the answer content.

5.2 Question-Answer Structure

Score: 2/3

FAQ sections exist on homepage (6 items) and blog posts (3 items each). However, no FAQPage JSON-LD schema markup exists. Answers appear collapsed/hidden in HTML.

5.3 Definition Blocks

Score: 0/2

No standalone definition blocks that AI systems can extract as authoritative answers. No glossary, no 'What is a riddle?' content.

5.4 Step-by-Step Content

Score: 0/2

Zero step-by-step content. No 'How to solve riddles' guide, no 'How to host a riddle night' tutorial. This is prime AEO material being wasted.

5.5 Comparison Content

Score: 0/2

No comparison tables or structured comparison content. No 'Riddles vs. Brain Teasers vs. Puzzles' comparison.

AEO Total Score: 5/15

6. GEO (Generative Engine Optimization) Audit

6.1 Entity Clarity

Score: 2/3

Brand 'Riddles Rush' is clearly defined internally. Creator Patrick Stevens named on About page. However, uses Vercel subdomain (riddles-rush-five.vercel.app) which dilutes brand authority. No external entity proof exists.

6.2 Source-Worthiness for AI Systems

Score: 0/3

Signal	Status
Original content	Mechanically paraphrased -- not truly original
Citations/references	Zero citations or source attributions
Evidence-backed claims	No statistical or factual assertions
Fresh content signals	No dates, no freshness metadata
Content depth	Riddles are thin by nature; no editorial content
Unique value proposition	Standard riddle format -- nothing unique vs competitors

6.3 AI Search Visibility Results

Score: 0/4

Search Query	Result
riddles with answers	NOT FOUND -- dominated by riddles.com, parade.com
best riddle collections online	NOT FOUND
campfire riddles	NOT FOUND
tricky riddles with answers	NOT FOUND
riddles rush (brand)	NOT FOUND on any search engine

GEO Total Score: 3/15

7. AI Search Visibility Audit

7.1 Critical Indexing Blockers

Issue	Severity	Impact
robots.txt returns 404	CRITICAL	Crawlers cannot find directives
sitemap.xml returns 404	CRITICAL	No page discovery map for crawlers
No canonical tags	CRITICAL	Duplicate content risk, diluted equity
No Open Graph tags	CRITICAL	Poor social/AI sharing previews
No JSON-LD structured data	CRITICAL	Zero schema markup across entire site
No Twitter Card tags	HIGH	Minimal Twitter/X previews
Vercel subdomain	HIGH	Hurts brand authority and AI citation

7.2 What Works

Signal	Status
Server-side rendered HTML	PASS -- content is SSR'd via Next.js
Meta description	PASS -- present on all pages tested
Page titles	PASS -- descriptive and keyword-rich
Image alt text	PASS -- all images have descriptive alt attributes
Heading hierarchy	PASS -- proper H1 > H2 > H3 structure
FAQ sections	PASS -- present on homepage and blog pages
Internal linking	PASS -- good cross-linking between categories
Mobile responsive	PASS -- responsive with proper viewport meta
HTTPS	PASS -- full HTTPS with HSTS

7.3 Conversation SEO

Score: 2/10

The site cannot answer full human decision questions:

- 'Which riddle website has the best collections?' -- No comparison content
- 'Where can I find riddles for kids with answers?' -- Page exists but not structured as direct answer
- 'What's a good riddle for a campfire?' -- Page exists but answers hidden behind JS
- 'Are there free riddle collections online?' -- No pricing/free-tier content

8. Entity SEO Audit

Score: 3/15

8.1 Brand Entity Profile

Entity Element	Status	Details
Organization name	PASS	Riddles Rush consistently used
Creator/Person	PASS	Patrick Stevens (About page)
Contact email	PASS	contact@patrickws.com
Custom domain	FAIL	Uses Vercel subdomain
Wikipedia page	FAIL	None
LinkedIn company	FAIL	None
Social profiles	PARTIAL	Pinterest/YouTube links (unverified)
Knowledge panel	FAIL	None
External mentions	FAIL	Zero backlink/mention presence

8.2 Schema Markup Analysis

Schema Type	Status
Organization	NOT IMPLEMENTED
Person (Patrick Stevens)	NOT IMPLEMENTED
WebSite	NOT IMPLEMENTED
Article/BlogPosting	NOT IMPLEMENTED
FAQPage	NOT IMPLEMENTED
BreadcrumbList	NOT IMPLEMENTED
ItemList	NOT IMPLEMENTED

9. Reputation SEO Audit

Score: 1/10

Proof Source	Status	Action
Google Reviews	NONE	Create and optimize Google Business Profile
Product Hunt	NONE	Launch on Product Hunt
Reddit mentions	NONE	Engage in r/riddles community
Twitter/X mentions	NONE	Build social presence
Hacker News	NONE	Consider Show HN for the app
Tech blogs	NONE	Pitch to edtech/fun sites

App Store reviews

UNVERIFIED

App listed but reviews unknown

Pinterest presence

UNVERIFIED

Link exists, content unverified

YouTube presence

UNVERIFIED

Link exists, content unverified

10. 30/60/90-Day Growth Plan

30 Days -- Technical Remediation (Must Fix Now)

Priority: Critical. These fixes block ALL search visibility.

1. Create robots.txt with User-agent: *, Allow: /, Sitemap: directive
2. Create dynamic sitemap.xml using Next.js app/sitemap.ts for all 661 pages
3. Add canonical tags to every page via metadata.alternates.canonical
4. Add Open Graph tags (og:title, og:description, og:image, og:url, og:type)
5. Add Twitter Card tags (twitter:card, twitter:title, twitter:description)
6. Add FAQPage JSON-LD schema to all blog posts with FAQ sections
7. Add Article/BlogPosting JSON-LD to all blog posts
8. Add WebSite + Organization JSON-LD to homepage
9. Add BreadcrumbList JSON-LD to all pages with breadcrumbs
10. Fix duplicate titles on /blog and /riddle-of-the-day
11. Fix duplicate meta descriptions on /blog and /riddle-of-the-day

60 Days -- Content & Authority (High Impact)

Priority: High. These improvements drive ranking and AI citation potential.

1. Expand blog posts from avg 86 words to 300-500+ words with original content
2. Add author bylines and expertise signals to all blog posts
3. Create 'What is a Riddle?' definitional content block for AEO
4. Create 'How to Solve Tricky Riddles' step-by-step guide
5. Create 'Riddles vs. Brain Teasers vs. Puzzles' comparison page
6. Make riddle answers server-rendered (not hidden behind JS toggles)
7. Add 'last updated' dates to all content pages
8. Create author profile page with credentials and expertise
9. Expand About page to 1,500+ words with expertise signals
10. Add security headers (CSP, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options)

90 Days -- Growth & Reputation (Strategic Build)

Priority: Medium. These actions build long-term authority and AI visibility.

1. Migrate to custom domain (e.g., riddlesrush.com)
2. Submit to Google Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools
3. Launch on Product Hunt and engage Reddit riddle communities

4. Create pillar content for each category (1,500+ words)
5. Build backlinks through guest posts on education/family sites
6. Add user engagement metrics (solve counts, visitor counts)
7. Create comparison content: 'Best Riddle Sites 2026'
8. Monitor AI search visibility across ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity
9. Build external entity profiles (LinkedIn, Crunchbase, Wikipedia)
10. Create 'Riddle of the Day' with structured data for freshness signals

11. Exact Next Actions

These are the specific code changes needed, in priority order:

FILE: public/robots.txt (NEW)

Create with: User-agent: *, Allow: /, Sitemap: <https://riddles-rush-five.vercel.app/sitemap.xml>

FILE: src/app/sitemap.ts (NEW)

Dynamic sitemap generating URLs for all 472 blog posts, 94 riddle pages, 8 categories, 39 pagination pages, and 7 utility pages

FILE: src/app/layout.tsx (MODIFY)

Add: openGraph, twitter, alternates.canonical, metadataBase to root metadata export

FILE: src/app/blog/page.tsx (MODIFY)

Add: metadata export with unique title 'Riddle Collections | Riddles Rush' and unique description

FILE: src/app/blog/[slug]/page.tsx (MODIFY)

Add: FAQPage JSON-LD schema, Article/BlogPosting schema, BreadcrumbList schema, openGraph in generateMetadata

FILE: src/app/riddles/[slug]/page.tsx (MODIFY)

Add: BreadcrumbList schema, openGraph in generateMetadata

FILE: src/app/riddle-of-the-day/page.tsx (MODIFY)

Add: metadata export with unique title and description

12. Data Not Available / Needed Next

The following data was not available during this audit and would improve accuracy:

1. Google Search Console data -- Required to verify actual indexing status, impressions, clicks, and keyword rankings
2. Google Analytics data -- Required to verify actual traffic, user behavior, and conversion rates
3. Ahrefs/Semrush/Moz data -- Required to verify backlink count, domain authority, referring domains, and competitor analysis
4. Apify API token -- Would enable automated crawling, SERP scraping, and competitor analysis at scale
5. Custom domain -- The Vercel subdomain significantly limits brand authority and AI citation potential
6. Google Business Profile -- If targeting local audiences, GBP optimization would be critical
7. PageSpeed Insights API -- Would provide detailed Core Web Vitals and performance recommendations

Recommended next step: Set up Google Search Console, submit the sitemap, and verify indexation status within 2 weeks of technical fixes.

Disclaimer: This audit was conducted using the Beyond SEO v1.0.3 methodology in Native Agent Scraping Mode. No APIFY, GSC, GA4, Ahrefs, Semrush, or Moz data was available. All findings are based on live HTTP crawling and source code inspection. Scores and recommendations should be validated with actual search console and analytics data when available. No guarantees of ranking improvement are made or implied.